## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** Ogden Nash | Nash. |
| 2 | **(c)** safe cage | He was timid. |
| 3 | **(a)** little | Describes house. |
| 4 | **(b)** Custard | Custard. |
| 5 | **(a)** pirate | He gobbled him. |
| 6 | **(b)** enclosure | Enclosed place. |
| 7 | **(b)** Belinda | Belinda. |
| 8 | **(d)** funny | Humorous. |
| 9 | **(a)** rhymes | Rhymed. |
| 10 | **(a)** white house | Little white house. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Ogden Nash (1) an American poet (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | A pirate (1) with weapons (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Dragon is a coward (1) yet saves the day (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Belinda (1) with her pets (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | A dragon (1). Sharp teeth (1). Timid (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | All praise him (1). He still wants a cage (1). Funny end (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | The dragon is big (1). The pirate has a sword (1). Both are nouns (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Kitten Ink (1). Mouse Blink (1). Dog Mustard and dragon Custard (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Realio trulio (1). Ink and Blink (1). Mustard and Custard (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** A part (1). Why (1). A feeling (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Belinda's pets (1). Custard's fear (1). Pirate (1). Pets run (1). Custard wins (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Meaning (1). Example (1). Custard (1). Our life (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Sharp teeth (1). Spikes (1). Scales (1). Timid (1). Hero (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Entry (1). Weapons (1). Pets run (1). Custard (1). End (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** mythical creature | Myth. |
| 2 | **(a)** afraid | Fearful. |
| 3 | **(d)** black | Black. |
| 4 | **(b)** cowardly | Brave x cowardly. |
| 5 | **(b)** a | Consonant sound. |
| 6 | **(d)** grey | Grey. |
| 7 | **(d)** gentle | Fierce x gentle. |
| 8 | **(a)** America | American. |
| 9 | **(a)** yellow | Yellow. |
| 10 | **(d)** pirates | Add s. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Ran away (1) and hid (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | True courage (1) is shown in deeds (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Ink, Blink (1) Mustard and Custard (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Gobbled up the pirate (1) and saved everyone (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Came in (1). Had weapons (1). Frightened them (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | A girl (1). Brave (1). Lives in a little house (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Name (1). Reason (1). Example (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Stayed (1). Attacked (1). Ate the pirate (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Be brave in action (1). Don't boast (1). Be kind (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** They make us laugh (1). They are easy (1). They carry a message (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | American (1). Poet (1). Humorous verse (1). Custard (1). Rhymes (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Courage (1). Humility (1). Deeds (1). Fun (1). Kindness (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Address (1). Greeting (1). Story (1). Fun (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Line 1 (1). Line 2 (1). Line 3 (1). Line 4 (1). Rhyme (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** shy | Fearful. |
| 2 | **(b)** pirate | Pirate. |
| 3 | **(b)** ran | Run-ran-run. |
| 4 | **(d)** story in verse | Narrative poem. |
| 5 | **(a)** weapons | Dangerous items. |
| 6 | **(d)** dragon | Name. |
| 7 | **(b)** Custard | Dragon. |
| 8 | **(a)** Custard | Dragon. |
| 9 | **(b)** shouted | Action. |
| 10 | **(d)** brave | Brave. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Couplets (1) with a bouncing rhythm (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | A pet dragon (1) with sharp teeth but a timid nature (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | A safe cage (1) because he was afraid (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | A coward (1) because he cried for a cage (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Ran (1). Hid (1). Cried (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | cowardly (1). gentle (1). leave (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | A sea robber (1). Armed (1). Dangerous (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** He saved them (1). He faced danger (1). He did not boast (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | ran (1). ate (1). hid (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** A little white house (1). Belinda's home (1). One day (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Date (1). Morning (1). Pirate (1). Custard (1). Thanks (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Greeting (1). Custard (1). Real heroes (1). Appeal (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Greeting (1). Boast (1). Pirate (1). Fear (1). End (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Name (1). Looks (1). Habits (1). Fun (1). Love (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
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- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

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